Beaked Yucca

Yucca rostrata

Family: Not stated Also known as: —

GARDENS Rockery: 2 **TOTAL 2**



Summer / form
Library candidate

Not available

Fall color
Not available

Not available

Flower
Not available



Leaf close-up
Library candidate

QUICK FACTS & PLANTING

Type: Tree
Evergreen/Deciduous: Evergreen
Mature size: 6–15 ft (most sources 6–12 ft; some note up to 15 ft with age). × 3–10 ft crown (sources range from 3–5 ft to 4–10 ft).
Hardiness / Zone 8a: Suitable for Zone 8a. Hardy in Zones 5–10 (sources range 5–12). Tolerates Atlanta heat and humidity provided drainage is excellent. Not stated for specific Atlanta winter wet-soil notes.
Sun: Full sun.
Water: Low. Excellent drought tolerance once established. Occasional summer irrigation optional.
Soil: Sharply drained, sandy, gravelly, or rocky. Tolerates alkaline to neutral. Does not tolerate wet feet.
Growth rate: Not stated
Not stated
Planting:
Siting: Plant in full sun and extremely well-drained soil. Do not amend with heavy organic matter that retains water. Water sparingly after establishment. Protect from prolonged wet soil in winter. Can be transplanted easily when young. Remove dead leaves if desired for cleaner trunk.
Soil prep: Sharply drained, sandy, gravelly, or rocky. Tolerates alkaline to neutral. Does not tolerate wet feet.
Depth/spacing: Not stated
Season: Not stated
Establishment: Not stated

ORIGIN, CHARACTERISTICS & HEALTH

Origin / native: Native to the Chihuahuan Desert region of West Texas and northern Mexico. No cultivar selection history (species form).
Form / habit: Slow-growing evergreen trunk-forming yucca. Single trunk with dense spherical rosette of stiff blue-gray leaves. Architectural.
Foliage: None (evergreen).
Flowers / fruit: Not stated
Bark / stem: Fibrous trunk. Dead leaves may persist on trunk unless removed.
Not stated
Health:
Health notes: No serious problems stated by the majority of sources. Generally pest and disease free when drainage is correct. Overwatering is the primary risk (root rot).
Not stated
Additional:
- White to cream flower panicles in late spring to summer (not every year). - Sharp-tipped blue-gray leaves in a dense rosette. - Very slow growth rate. - Highly heat and cold tolerant within zone range. - Architectural specimen for dry sites. - Flowering reliability in Zone 8a: Not stated.

Sources: - Gardenia.net Yucca rostrata profile - SiteOne product page - RHS plant profile - NC State Extension Gardener Plant Toolbox - Native plant